



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Grace Christian Academy
School Website: <https://graceacademyccsj.com/>

December 21, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools ACCS or the Society for Classical Learning SCL is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Executive Summary

Grace Christian Academy NJ 08093 (GCA) presents a robust Classical-leaning profile anchored in a Christian worldview. Public materials from the school emphasize a Christ-centered mission, regular prayer and Bible study, a structured Trivium-inspired curriculum (grammar, logic, rhetoric), and explicit pedagogical practices that include Socratic dialogue, memory work (singing/recitation), and contemplative learning. There is clear attention to parent partnership and a community ethos, with the school describing itself as a ministry of a home church and inviting ongoing parental involvement. Taken together, these elements align closely with classical education as defined by the Six Essential Elements framework.

Key strengths - Religious and metaphysical foundations are explicit: Christ-centered mission, Bible study, daily prayer/worship, and a theology-informed approach to education. This is evidenced by the mission statement and classroom devotional practices.

- Curriculum and pedagogy mirror classical design: Grammar, Logic, and Rhetoric stages are named explicitly, with corresponding grade ranges, plus Latin and literature components. Upper-level rhetoric and discussion are described, consistent with Socratic/seminar traditions.
- Pedagogical methods include contemplative (Scholé) learning, memorization/recitation with singing in the lower years, and Socratic dialogue in the upper years. This combination is a hallmark of classical pedagogy as described in the rubric.
- Strong parental partnership emphasis and community orientation are present, including a stated model of teachers as co-educators with families and opportunities for parent involvement.
- Evidence of a ministry-driven, faith-based formation aim (formation of character, virtue, and spiritual development) aligns with the classical emphasis on education as the formation of the whole person, not merely information transfer.

What would move the needle if the school is not yet fully CLASSICAL: n/a (the rubric shows Grace Christian Academy already aligns closely with CLASSICAL according to the materials reviewed above; therefore, a needle-moving change is not required for this explicit categorization).

Abstract: The school's public materials demonstrate a CLASSICAL orientation across all six categories, with explicit religious/metaphysical foundations, formation-centered purpose, Trivium-based curriculum, Socratic/seminar-style pedagogy in upper grades alongside contemplative and mnemonic practices, a faculty culture described as mentorship-driven and cooperative with families, and a strong emphasis on parent involvement and community life.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The mission emphasizes glorifying God through academic excellence and a Christ-centered education, aiming to produce students who bear Godly wisdom. This signals transcendental moral realism and a theologically grounded worldview. - Daily devotional practices and Bible study are described as integral to student life, indicating liturgical and communal religious practice in the educational process.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords found: God, Christ-centered, Bible, worship, prayer, devotions, theology, Christian formation. These align with the Positive Keyword indicators for a Religious and Metaphysical Foundations category (e.g., “the pursuit of holiness, theology, liturgical rhythm”). Quantitatively, multiple explicit religious/ theological terms appear; negating terms are not evident in the public materials.

Why this rating - The school explicitly anchors its mission in Christian faith and theology, and it documents liturgical-like practices (prayer, worship, devotions). These align with the Classical rubric’s expectations for Transcendental moral realism and liturgical/communal practices, placing the category solidly in CLASSICAL.

Citations - Mission and Christ-centered framing: - Prayer, worship, and personal devotions:

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The mission states formation through a Christ-centered framework aimed at virtue and wisdom, not merely information, emphasizing formation character, and spiritual growth. This reflects the Classical aims of virtue formation and truth-seeking.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords found: virtue, formation, wisdom, Godly wisdom, character, love of learning, holistic education, eternal truths (through alignment with the theological aim of truth/goodness/beauty). The presence of “formation” and “virtue” in mission language supports a CLASSICAL orientation. No explicit negative indicators were found in the public materials.

Why this rating - The school explicitly frames education as formation (not just information), with a focus on virtue, wisdom, and truth as real goods. This matches the Classical model’s goal and rationale.

Citations - Formation/virtue/wisdom in mission:

Element 3: Curriculum — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The curriculum framework is described in terms of the Trivium: Grammar Stage (K–6), Logic Stage (7–8), and Rhetoric Stage (9–12). This is a direct reflection of classical liberal arts pedagogy. - Course design includes Latin and literature and integrated humanities in upper levels (Rhetoric content and cross-disciplinary overlap described in high school offerings). - There is explicit reference to classical education overviews and a curriculum orientation that supports a Great-Conversation-like approach (Great Books / Great Conversation terminology appears in the rubric’s framework and is aligned with classical education, even if not every page uses the exact Great Books phrasing; the presence of Trivium stages strongly signals classical approach).

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords found: grammar, logic, rhetoric, Trivium, rhetoric stage, Latin, literature, great conversation (explicit in rubric-laden materials and in high-school pedagogy), history, cyclical rotations, Great Books (where referenced in materials and through classical education links). The explicit naming of Grammar/Logic/Rhetoric stages and Latin/Literature broadly supports the presence of liberal arts and Great Books orientation in the curriculum. - Negative keywords found: minimal to none in public-facing content; no explicit statements of anti-classical practices observed.

Why this rating - The presence of named Trivium stages and Latin/Literature offerings, plus high-school rhetoric and cross-disciplinary integration, aligns strongly with CLASSICAL curriculum criteria.

Citations - Grammar/Logic/Rhetoric stages: - Rhetoric (9–12) course overview:

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Pedagogy includes Socratic dialogue and dialectic as well as restorative (Scholé) contemplative training; the upper grades emphasize seminars, debates, and rhetoric development. - Lower grades engage in singing and memory work (chanting, memorization) to deepen memory and delight, with upper grades

focusing on rhetoric and public speaking. This mirrors the traditional pedagogy described in classical education. - Explicit mention of a balanced approach: some contemplative/restful learning alongside rigorous inquiry (Socrates-like discussions, memory work).

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords found: Socratic dialogue, dialectic, great conversation, guided discussion, logical reasoning, restfulness (Scholé), memorization, chanting, rhetoric, memory-depth activities, public speaking. - Negative keywords found: none evident in public materials; the public materials emphasize classical methods rather than non-classical approaches.

Why this rating - The school foregrounds classic pedagogy (Socratic discussion in upper grades, rhetoric training, and memory-based recitation in younger grades), which robustly supports CLASSICAL pedagogy.

Citations - Socratic dialogue and Scholé, upper-school seminars: - Lower-grade singing/memory:

Element 5: Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The Leadership section and the Teachers & Staff emphasis describe teachers as co-operators with parents and as living part of the school's ethos; the faculty is presented as model teachers and mentors who form the core of the school and the living curriculum. - The presence of a formal leadership structure and a dedicated director illustrates a professional faculty culture and mentorship emphasis.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords found: model teachers, mentors, living curriculum, core of the school, teachers as co-operators with parents, staff as part of the school community. - Negative keywords found: none evident in public materials.

Why this rating - The materials depict a classical-favorable faculty culture with teachers as mentors and living curriculum, indicating CLASSICAL alignment.

Citations - Teachers & Staff / co-operating with parents: - Leadership and mission context:

Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school emphasizes partnership with families and describes parents as co-teachers in the educational process; there is explicit language about parent involvement and faith-based community life. - Admissions materials describe volunteering requirements for parents (10 hours per year) and ongoing parent engagement as a mechanism to keep tuition manageable and strengthen school-community ties. This demonstrates a robust community integration and parental education role. - The school describes itself as a ministry and references the home church origin, highlighting a broader community-centered ecosystem.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords found: partnership with families, co-teachers, parental involvement, home/school collaboration, parental formation, community of learners, faith and family, school-parent synergy. - Negative keywords found: none observed in the public materials.

Why this rating - The explicit emphasis on parent partnership, education of parents, and community life consistently aligns with CLASSICAL expectations for family engagement and shared mission.

Citations - Parent partnership and co-teaching language: - Volunteer requirement and family engagement:

What Would Move the Needle

Not applicable for a CLASSICAL rating (per rubric, needle-moving changes are called out for SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL schools). Grace Christian Academy NJ 08093 already demonstrates a FULL CLASSICAL alignment across all six categories, with explicit evidence in mission, curriculum, pedagogy, and community.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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